

1.

One goal of the ECA project is to prepare primary school teachers to provide students with the greatest possible learning autonomy in the safest possible learning environment. Another goal is to reinforce the attitude of person-centred education provide practical tools for person-centred, ECA-based education in primary school.

- *Find games, templates, lesson plans and checklists on the website: www.ecaproject.eu.*



2.

Traditional interactive lesson or ECA lesson

Consider-ation	Interactive tradi-tional class	ECA class
Motivation	Grade	Unique experience
Assess-ment	Grading based on performance	Process-oriented self-assessment
Differenti-ation	Difficult to solve	Naturally comes
Action	Limited	Multiple experien-tial, movements
Cognitive processing	Frontal, based on instructions	Self-contained, ex-ploring, individual
Emotional involvement	Low-medium	High
Role of the learner	Student recep-tive	Active experimen-tal
Focus	Transfer of knowl-edge	Experiences, com-plex development
Mode of operation	Instructions, problem solving	Unique products, complex

- *What do you agree and disagree with?*
- *Was there anything in the table that surprised you or made you think?*
- *What would you change if you could?*



3.

Emotion: connection, reading emotional states, emotional framing, a step towards cognition

Cognition: shared focus, discovery, organising together, brief consolidation

Action: transition into action, creation or practice, sharing, reflection

- *How would you rank the three components in order of importance?*
- *What do you think is missing from the list?*



4.

What does preparation mean for an ECA teacher?

1. **Defining the aim of the lesson** – no change.

2. **Selecting the learning content and linking it to previous learning** – no change

3. **Emotions:** Normally we include a short warm-up, but here this part is more detailed.

4. **Preparing the activities:** We usually don't prepare so many tasks to choose from.

5. **Preparing the resources:** Here we prepare for several different areas of intelligence.

6. **Preparing the materials and tools:** Diversity may mean more work.

- *How does it feel that preparation needs more energy.*
- *What can you get for the energy invested?*



5.

How can we create an appropriate, motivating and developmental learning environment for each student in a group?
We are different – accepting this fundamentally shapes the teacher's attitude.

- *What systems can you think of that support the idea that "we are different"?*
- *What would you include in an Individual Learning Contract?*
- *Think of your current class and write down the initials of three students who are very different from one another in terms of learning. In one word for each, name what makes them different learners.*
- *Decide which of them you will make one small personalised adjustment for next week (a different tool, different amount of work, a different type of task).*



6.

Learning is person-centred to the extent that self-assessment dominates the assessment process. This is what Carl Rogers states.

- *Think about how often you ask children: "How would you assess your work today?" Write down your honest estimate (never, sometimes, often).*
- *Write down two simple self-assessment questions that you will try at the end of a lesson next week.*
- *What is the relationship between the experience of success and self-assessment?*



7.

Self-reflection in the development of teacher competencies is not a separate technique, but a consequence of the approach that permeates the whole ECA perspective.

- *Choose one of the teacher roles (e.g. facilitator, mentor, team player) and mark on a scale of 1–10 how comfortable you currently feel in that role.*
- *In one sentence, describe a situation in which you will consciously practise this role next week (e.g. "during this group activity, I will only ask questions and will not provide solutions").*



8.



- *What elements make up your own practice? What are its intellectual and philosophical foundations, and what are its supporting pillars? What are its decorative elements? Which architectural style would you borrow to present ypur current teaching style?*
- *Formulate your teaching credo in five simple sentences.*



9.



- *Think through which of the above elements you provide in your classroom and which you do not.*

- *What would you change in the picture? What would you remove? What is missing? Adapt the picture to yourself.*



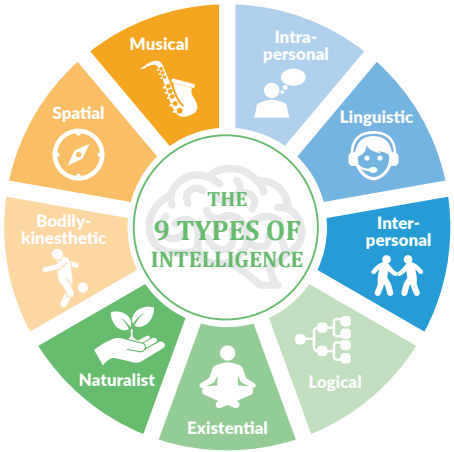
10.



- *Is student autonomy important to you? If yes, why? If not, why not?*
- *Think about how and to what extent you create situations for autonomous decision-making in your own classroom. Are you satisfied with this?*



11.

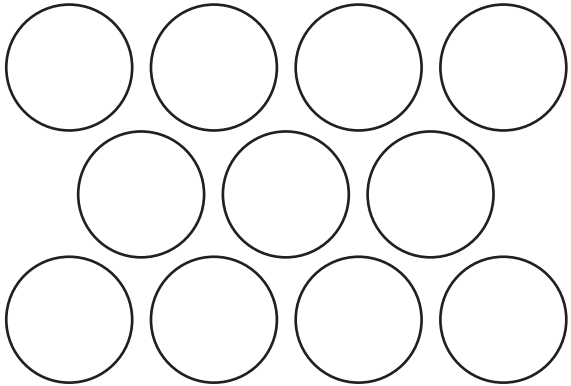


- *Think of five people in whom you recognise one of these intelligences. Describe what they are like.*
- *Which area are you good at? Which one is difficult for you?*
- *Design a lesson plan in which representatives of at least seven intelligences can find something enjoyable.*
- *Have you ever felt in your life that you were worth more than what teachers saw in you?*



12.

One useful tool for measuring creativity is the Torrance Test. It measures different areas of creativity, most commonly examining the quantity, variety, originality and elaboration of generated ideas.



- *Do a part of the test. Complete the circles so that they become as many different and interesting drawings as possible. Try to draw ideas that are varied and unusual. You may also give your drawings titles.*
- *What did this task mean to you?*



13.



Gary Chapman says: a Love language is the way a person expresses and experiences love. It is important to note that everyone speaks all of the languages, but each person has one (or two) primary loved one. It is a possibility to fill the "love tanks". Using them well, goodwill and care can reach children more easily. It is also be very helpful when giving assessment and feedback.

- *Which love language is the easiest for you to use to express your love, and which is the most difficult?*



14.

Person-centred attitude

Mark 0 = never/rarely / 1 = often / 2 = characteristic

Use:

- Observation
- Self-reflection
- Professional dialogue

Connection and safety

- I am present as an accepting, calm teacher. I can accept every child.
- Children feel safe enough to speak up.
- I encourage them to work and to make mistakes.
- I do not tell off them if they do not understand the task

Autonomy and participation

- I offer genuine choices.
- Children shape the process.

Communication and feedback

- I use descriptive, non-judgemental feedback.
- Questioning and reflecting back dominate.

Learning process

- The emphasis is on the process, not on the results.
- Conflicts are treated as learning situations.
- I have opportunities to teach them assertive communication.

Reflection

- There is closure and looking back every day.
- I use self-reflection on a daily basis.

Notes / direction for development:

- *What do you think it feels like to teach with this attitude?*



15.

Here are a few points that build a more personal relationship with students (mentoring role).

- Take time to truly listen to the child, noticing non-verbal signals as well.
- Consciously identify and reinforce each child's individual strengths.
- Respect rules of trust and confidentiality.
- Develop individual goals with each child; look for and observe changes together.
- Be consistent and authentic, and set an example.
- Give regular, constructive feedback.
- Active listening and empathy, supportive responses and a non-judgemental attitude are all important.
- Precise self-expression, honesty, flexibility and adaptability – practise them.

• *For at least five of these points, write one example of how it appears in your own life.*

• *Collect the obstacles and concerns you have in relation to these points.*

• *How much pressure do you feel when reading these points?*



16.

Emotional intelligence includes, among other things, self-awareness and emotional awareness.

- Recognising and naming one's own emotions in different situations.
- Being self-reflective.
- Recognising and managing one's own motivations in one's behaviour.
- Consciously integrating the connections between emotional and bodily reactions.

• *Imagine a child who is shouting, hitting things, clenching their fists, and using offensive language with a red face. You can see that the child is angry. List all the feelings that might be hidden behind this anger.*

• *What makes you feel angry?*



17.

Routines and subroutines help you stay on the person-centred path.

- Arrival and settling in:
- Opportunity to indicate one's state:
- Building in choice points: Genuine choices regularly appear during the day (task, tool, pace, role).
- Brief shared framing
- Action-based learning
- Flexible time management
- Observation instead of evaluation
- Treating conflicts as learning situations
- Closure and looking back
- Predictable, human presence

• *Please make a list of why, in your view, routines are important. Do not make the list from the teacher's or the class's perspective, but in terms of their impact on the individual.*
Why are routines good for a young child?

• *Choose one point and work out how you would apply it in your own lesson.*
How will you implement it?

• *What does it feel like to work with these tools?*



18.

This is a suggestion for self-reflection with younger primary school children. It is aimed at helping them understand that mistakes are a natural part of learning. It is worth using one or two of these each day.

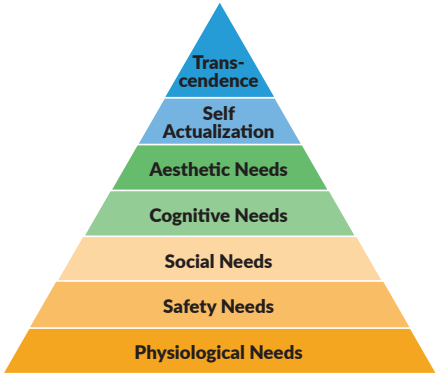
- What was I good at today?
- What was difficult at first, but then I managed it?
- What was very difficult, but I solved it?
- What do I need help with?
- What am I afraid of?
- What do I need to improve so that I can do a task even better next time?
- What did I discover that I can already do well?
- What am I better at today than I was yesterday?
- Did I make a mistake today? If yes, what will my next step be to avoid it next time?
- What am I proud of?

- *Do one of the exercises about this day of yours.*
- *Find something you can be proud of today.*
- *What does it feel like to be allowed to make mistakes?*



19.

Maslow's pyramid reminds us that higher-level learning goals can only be achieved when a person's basic physical, safety and relational needs are adequately met. As teachers, we always consider which level needs urgent attention at the moment – rest, safety, acceptance or challenge.



- *Create your own learning petrol station = what helps you be filled up: rest, safety, friends, challenge Is there another pump you would add?*

- *How would you feel in a place where none of these needs were taken into account, and in a place where they were?*



20.

Below you can read a few steps of mediation:

- I stop the situation: “Let’s stop for a moment. What happened here is important.”
- I listen to both sides separately: “Tell me what happened from your point of view.”
- Naming feelings: “How did that feel for you? Were you embarrassed…?”
- Expressing a need or request: “What would you like to happen now? What are you asking from the other person?”
- Looking for a shared solution: “What solution could work for both of you?”
- Agreement and closure: “You have agreed that… What will you try next time?”

- *Imagine a conflict with one of your most difficult student. You want to use steps similar to these mediation steps. What do you do?*
  - *What would your first sentence be?*
  - *How would you describe what happened if you could only use I-messages and could only say how you feel? (You may not say “not again!”, “never” or “always”.)*
  - *How would you express empathy towards them?*
  - *How would you express your needs to them?*
  - *What solution would you suggest?*

- *How do you feel now? What thoughts come up?*
- *What will you do next time in a similar situation?*
- *How will you remind yourself of these steps?*